

MECHELSAOPAULOEDIT

Travel Radio Australia and we're talking to Michel Ayub from Sao Paulo. Now Michel, welcome to the program. Thank you very much, it's a pleasure to be with you.

And tell us a bit about your organization. I've always dreamed about going to Sao Paulo. I love cities like New York and Sao Paulo is like the New York of Brazil, isn't it? It's beautiful.

Yes, yes, it's very beautiful. It's one of the biggest cities in the world. We have around 12 million people in the city.

It's great, you need to go there. We have tourism, we have business, we have Formula One, we have Rock in Rio, we have lots of things. It's a fantastic place and it's vibrant and when they say the city of New York is the city that never sleeps, it's the same in Sao Paulo, right? Yes, I think a little bit more.

It's 24 hours for lots of stuff, mass supermarkets, restaurants and whatever you can imagine. It's a huge, huge city. Michel Ayub, and tell us a bit about the organization you're involved with.

We're here at the ILTM, the International Luxury Travel Market in Cannes in France and tell us about the organization that you're with, Forum de Turismo. We are here with Invest Sao Paulo and the Secretary of Tourism of Sao Paulo, city and state, developing our city to bring business, to bring tourism for our city. We have some players here, we have the market, municipal market, we have Formula One, work with the Forum 60 plus senior for travel agents.

We prepare these travel agents from all over Brazil to work with the senior traveling. That is increasing a lot in Brazil. We are already around 35 million people over 60 and traveling is the first that they want to do from now over.

So we bring hotels, airlines, transfer companies, destinies. We make a big meeting, big summit and from them we explain how to work from now on. That will increase a lot from now on.

Yes, certainly the 60 plus market is absolutely massive, especially from Australia. A lot of people work their whole lives and then they're in their retirement and they just want to do the world. They just say, I'm going to go traveling for six months.

It's a massive market and we would really encourage people to not only come to Europe but to Sao Paulo and Brazil as well. Lots of people come to Sao Paulo, Rio, Foz do Iguaçu. We have the beaches, we have Brazil.

It's a very big city. A big country. Traveling for this senior, it's great now.

They want experience. They want to go to Antarctica for example. They want to go to Australia.

They want to make a big jump. They don't have any more limits to live their lives. They already don't have children.

They have their cars and stuff. So traveling is what they do. They want to do more and more.

I'm sure that you're known as one of the Mr. Sao Paulo people. You know the city inside out. Can you give us a couple of your recommendations with people who have never been to the city before? Can you give a couple of really hidden gems that you would really recommend? We have like Ibirapuera Park.

It's a beautiful park in the middle of the city. We have the Mercado Municipal where you see fruits, exotic fruits. You can eat a mortadella sandwich that is very typical.

We have restaurants with the famous feijoada and caipirinha that people love it. We have Paulista Avenue where it's a financial area with museums, museums of arts. We have very close to Sao Paulo very nice beaches also.

We have Formula One. We have Lollapalooza. We have theaters.

We have cinemas. We have Michelin restaurants. You can spend lots of time there.

The public transport system is fantastic too. You don't really need a car in Sao Paulo. No, you don't need a car anyway.

We have very good metro, bus. It's very easy to go and come back so we don't need car. Sao Paulo is just going from strength to strength as a city itself.

Brazilian tourism overall as well. They could use Sao Paulo as a base to get to everywhere else too. Yes, Sao Paulo is a base of tourism especially for business.

We have all year lots of conventionals, meetings. We have four or five places that we make big meetings. Now we have the automobile fair show, big one showing all the new stuff coming and people from all over Brazil and South America come to see it.

Companies, whatever you see, they make big meetings. From Monday to Friday, Sao Paulo is very busy. On the weekends, it's better to have more fun, have less traffic and stuff.

And what's your background, Michel? How did you get involved in all this kind of thing? We work with the travel agency for more than 30 years. We call it AYUB Viagens. So we make outbound traveling.

We send people to Australia already, to Sydney, Melbourne and America, California, Europe, Dubai and then we are involved. And in the last years, we are focused, especially me, in this market 60 plus senior that is increasing every year. In 2050, we will be the sixth country with

more senior in the world.

So we need to prepare and explain how to work and it's a big market. And now especially the big festivals you have there too, some magnificent festivals in Sao Paulo. Could you tell us a bit of some of the big ones? We have very big festivals.

We have Lollapalooza, we have Rock in Rio, we have Formula One just finished with the city four. We have LGBT parade. We have, I think, all the year, things to do, you know.

Oasis just make a show there. So everybody that comes pass through Sao Paulo. And how can people find out more about Brazil in general online and your organization as well? You can find our media.

We have the Secretary of Tourism, Embratur. Our forum is in the forum 60 plus. This is especially for travel agent B2B.

All the media we have lots of things here. Sao Paulo Discovery City, all of this, we are together. Wonderful.

Well, thank you so much for being part of the program. Michel Ayub, and he's the sales manager with Barra Funda, Parafunda Brazil? Barra Funda is the neighborhood. Oh, yeah.

Oh, the neighborhood. Office. Like each neighborhood is a big city.

Exactly. Well, thank you so much for being part of the show and travel radio world. Thank you very much.

We appreciate. I hope to see you soon in Sao Paulo. And before you go, can you say something for us in your own native language from Brazil, in the Portuguese, I suppose, for our friends in Australia and America and around the world, and a big welcome in Portuguese.

Welcome to Sao Paulo. You will have an excellent stay. It is one of the largest cities in the world.

Night, life, party, business, what you can imagine, Sao Paulo has. Thanks, Michel. Thank you very much and hope to see you soon there.